

However, its real pioneering effort lay in the railways' food service, when it introduced in-transit catering through pantry cars attached to the trains. Now all passengers, no matter which class they had opted for, had access to hygienic food.

An element of risk

The IRCTC's next foray was into the world of ticket reservation in 2002 when they started offering online booking. In India, the internet was still in its infancy, e-commerce was uncharted territory, so customer reaction was bound to be quite unpredictable. This did not stop the IRCTC, which took all the challenges in its stride and launched what turned out to be hugely successful digital services for ticketing. It moved towards next generation e-ticketing with the launch of the IRCTC Rail Connect mobile application in 2014, which increased booking capacity to over 20,000 tickets per minute.



▲ **The IRCTC has set up** manufacturing plants to produce packaged drinking water, sold exclusively on all railway premises and trains.

Collaborations